



Equity Adaptive Framework

What is the
Equity Adaptive
Framework?

The Equity Adaptive Framework (EAF) is a structured way of asking:

“Is this decision actually fair, proportionate, consistent, and accountable – not merely technically correct or justified by a particular narrative?”

It is designed to evaluate **people, organisations, policies, rules, and systems** across many domains, rather than being tied to one political ideology or profession.

At its core, EAF looks at **six things**:

Intent – What was the actor trying to do? What did they know, foresee, or reasonably understand?

Harm – What actual, potential, indirect, systemic, or omission-based harm resulted?

Proportionality – Does the response or consequence match the seriousness and circumstances of what happened?

Accountability – Who actually had control or responsibility, and can responsibility be hidden behind hierarchy or bureaucracy?

Equity over technicality – Following a rule doesn't automatically make an outcome fair. EAF examines the substantive result as well as procedural compliance.

Consistency – Are comparable situations treated comparably, or is enforcement arbitrary, selective, or biased?

What makes EAF **different**?

EAF doesn't simply ask “**Which side is right?**”

Instead, it applies the **same evaluative logic regardless of who benefits from the conclusion**. If the evidence supports one political side in one situation, EAF can support that side; if the evidence supports the opposing side in another situation, it can support that instead.

So **political alignment is an outcome, not a starting assumption**.

It also recognises that people and institutions don't always have equal power or resources. A multinational corporation, government agency, individual consumer, and vulnerable person shouldn't necessarily be held to identical expectations when their **capacity, control, and burdens are radically different**.

A simple example

Suppose a company says:

“We followed our terms and conditions, therefore our decision was fair.”

EAF wouldn't stop there.
It would ask:

Intent: Was the rule being applied in good faith?

Harm: Who was harmed and how seriously?

Proportionality: Was the consequence excessive?

Accountability: Who designed or enforced the system?

Equity: Did the rule impose a disproportionate burden on the customer?

Consistency: Are similar customers treated similarly?

Power: Could the customer realistically challenge the company?

Alternatives: Could the company have prevented the harm reasonably?

The fact that something is **technically permitted** therefore isn't necessarily the end of the analysis.

EAF also deals with bad-faith behaviour

A major part of EAF is preventing systems from being gamed.

If someone deliberately exploits loopholes, refuses meaningful engagement, conceals relevant information, or creates foreseeable harm through negligence, EAF increases scrutiny rather than allowing that behaviour to undermine the evaluation.

Conversely, **good-faith actors aren't supposed to be punished disproportionately simply because they made an honest mistake or lack the resources of a more powerful actor.**

The important architectural idea

EAF separates its reasoning into two layers:

Layer 1 – Evaluative logic

The underlying principles and safeguards remain stable.

Layer 2 – Application

Those principles are translated into the specific rules and circumstances of law, business, technology, consumer rights, social policy, etc.

That means EAF can adapt to completely different domains **without changing its fundamental evaluative logic.**

EAF is a way of putting decisions under a consistent fairness-and-accountability test, regardless of who made the decision or which narrative surrounds it.

Discover more at eaf.dpdns.org